

your bank account's username and password, he creates an exact copy of the bank's web site, he then finds out your email address and mails you threatening that your account will be closed if you don't send fill in your login details.

Spam

Spam used to be junk or bulk email sent by the spammer to various recipients aimed at advertising, scamming or sending viruses. But over the years, it has developed and needs to be defined in a new way: any kind of unwanted information sent to you by an unverified source is spam.

Besides the usual emails, there are many fake sites popping up. They claim that you can "Earn \$8769/month right from your home". Sounds too good to be true, right? That's because it's spam. These links take you to fake web sites and the moment you enter your email address you become a part of a huge spam list and this is how you get 100s of spam mails a day. Even worse, the hacker can gain your personal information like your phone number and home address which can be used for identity theft. If you come across such links always remember "there is no free lunch".

Are your friends posting links on Facebook saying "OMG I can't believe this..."? If yes, they're victims of Clickjacking. This is how it works: when your friend clicks a link on Facebook saying "Best Justin Bieber video ever" s/he is asked to fill an online survey or subjected to some kind of ad. At the same time, the embedded code spreads via their profiles making it seem like they liked it and posted it on everyone's wall. This problem was prominent a few months ago but Facebook has tried to control it and also filed lawsuits against the perpetrators.

Spyware

Spyware is a type of malicious software employed by hackers and advertisers to achieve information about you without your knowledge. Spyware creators go to great lengths to ensure that their software remains undetected. It differs from a virus because a virus is a piece of code designed to replicate itself as many times as possible, spreading from one host computer to other computers connected to it and damages your operating system. A spyware is a code made just to track your activities. The damage it does is more of a by-product of its main mission, which is to serve you targeted advertisements or make your browser display certain sites or search results or even send your personal data to the attacker.